

Overview of DAWN Use Cases

Daniel King (Old Dog Consulting)

Kehan Yao (China Mobile)

Ken Adler (Indeed)

2026-07-20

Problem Statement

- Fragmented ecosystems & cross-domain invisibility
- Static configurations don't scale for large clusters
- Diverse entities & dynamic attributes

Next Step: Let's explore concrete use cases to define the essential capabilities a modern and common discovery mechanism must provide.

Four Categories of DAWN Use Cases

01. Capability-Oriented

Find entities by function/capability
(who can do this)

02. Resource-Oriented

Find entities by resource attributes
(where are suitable resources)

03. Administrative Scope Extensions

- Local (link/segment/physical space) discovery
- Cross-organization; cross-tenant discovery

04. Operational Discovery

Operations, audit, troubleshooting,
compliance, etc.

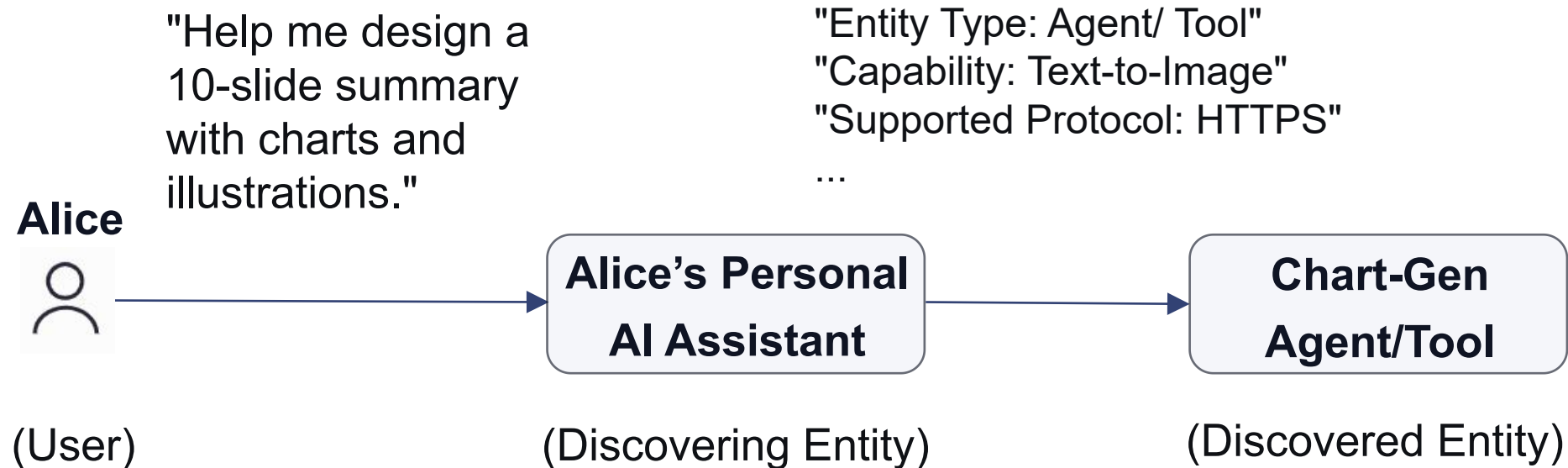
- The first two categories are foundational discovery use cases, while the latter two represent extensions or deployment variants.

1. Capability-oriented Discovery

Core Question: What specific actions, functions, or capabilities can an entity perform?

Description: Alice, an employee at Company A, needs to create a year-end summary slide deck.

Discovery Query:



- Multi-attribute Search
- Return sufficient metadata
(Endpoint URI, capability card, input/output format, etc)

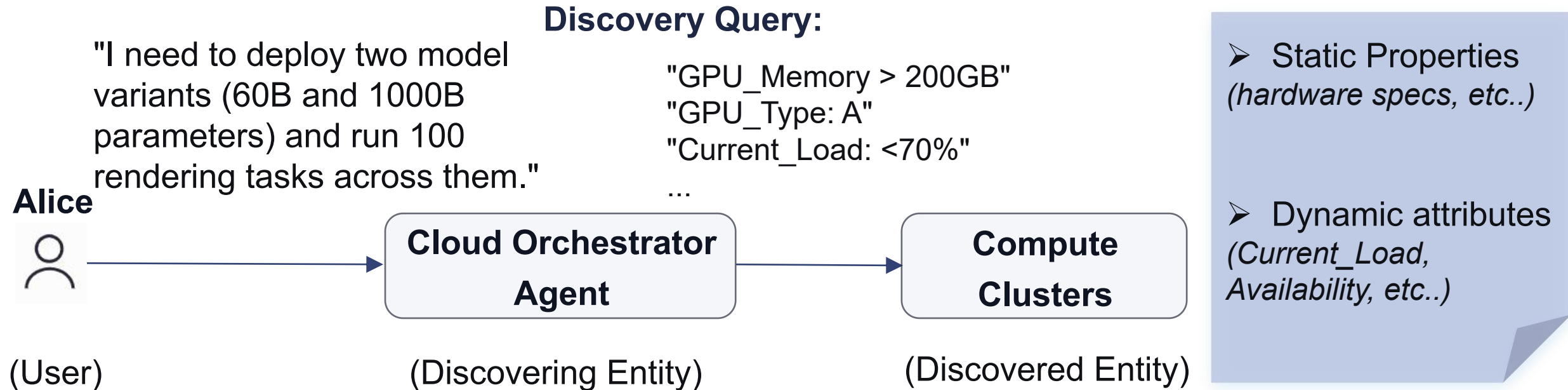
► While "capability" defines what an entity can do, discovery often needs to go further. In some cases, Service deployers/providers want to discover resources that can implement these functions/capabilities.



2. Resource-oriented Discovery

Core Question: What can be used to implement these functions, and where are they?

Description: Alice asks Cloud Orchestrator Agent to help deploy specific models and tasks.



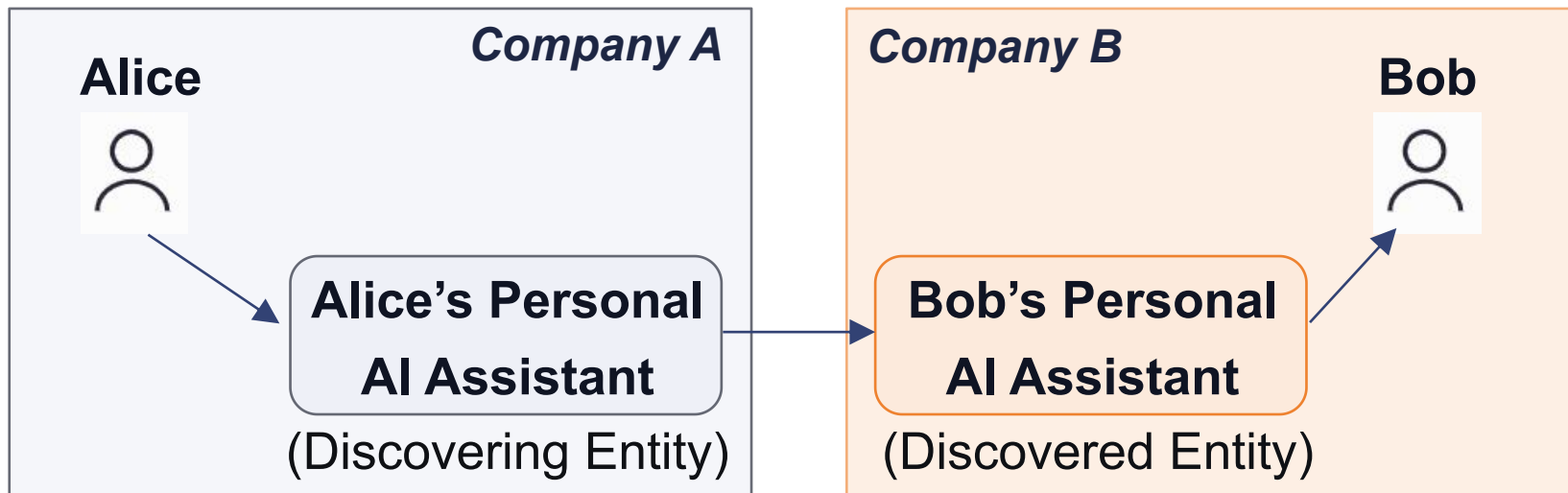
- ▶ The aforementioned “capability” search and “resource” search happen within a single administrative domain (Company A), but can extend to cross organizational boundaries.



3. Administrative Scope Extensions

Core Question: How does discovery work across organizations/tenants?

Description: Alice needs to schedule an online meeting with Bob (client customer) from Company B.



Discovery Query: "Target_domain: Company B" or
"Target_endpoint: Bob's assistant's URI"

➤ Trust indicators and delegation
(Need authentication of discovery information.)

Authentication of **discovered entity is out-of-scope.**)

➤ Decentralized architectures

► Discovery can also happen in OPS scenarios, which share similar patterns and characteristics.



4. Operational Discovery

Core Question: How does discovery support operations and troubleshooting?

Description: Alice, acting as a system administrator, asks the OAM agent for fault localization.

"Show me fault localization, system logs, and root cause analysis for the last 2 hours."

Discovery Query:

"Telemetry_Source": Source = "Network_Edge"

"Log_Indexer": Timeframe = "Last_2h"

"RCA_Engine": Capability = "Anomaly_Detection"

Alice



OAM Agent

- **Telemetry Source**
- **Log Indexer**
- **RCA Engine**
- **etc..**

- Human can also initiate discovery
- Discovery objective for audit trail
- Share similar discovery requirements

(Operator OR
Discovering Entity)

(Discovering Entity)

(Discovered Entity)

From Use Cases to Requirements Categorization

Use Case Observation	Core Requirement Category
Diverse entity types (Agents, Tools, Workloads, Services, Functions)	Entity Classification (REQ-CLASS-*)
Discovery of capabilities, resources, and cross-domain context	Discovery Actors & Scenarios (REQ-DISC-*)
Hybrid of static metadata and dynamic operational properties	Entity Properties Model (REQ-PROP-*)
Cross-organizational collaboration and decentralized networks	Scalability & Distributed Architecture (REQ-ARCH-*)
Need for trustworthy, verifiable, and secure discovery data	Trust & Security (REQ-SEC-*)